United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization

Intangible Cultural Heritage

Workshop on ratifying the Convention: introduction

Unit 16 PowerPoint Presentation 1

UNESCO
Intangible Cultural Heritage Section

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In this presentation …

- Obligations and recommendations for safeguarding in general
- Legal and administrative context
- Awareness-raising
- Identifying, inventorying
- Safeguarding measures for specific elements

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Obligations for safeguarding ICH in general

Each State Party shall …

- Ensure the safeguarding of the ICH **in its territory**
- Identify and define the ICH **with the participation of communities** concerned and relevant NGOs
- Draw up and regularly update an **inventory/inventories** of ICH

Recommendations for safeguarding ICH in general

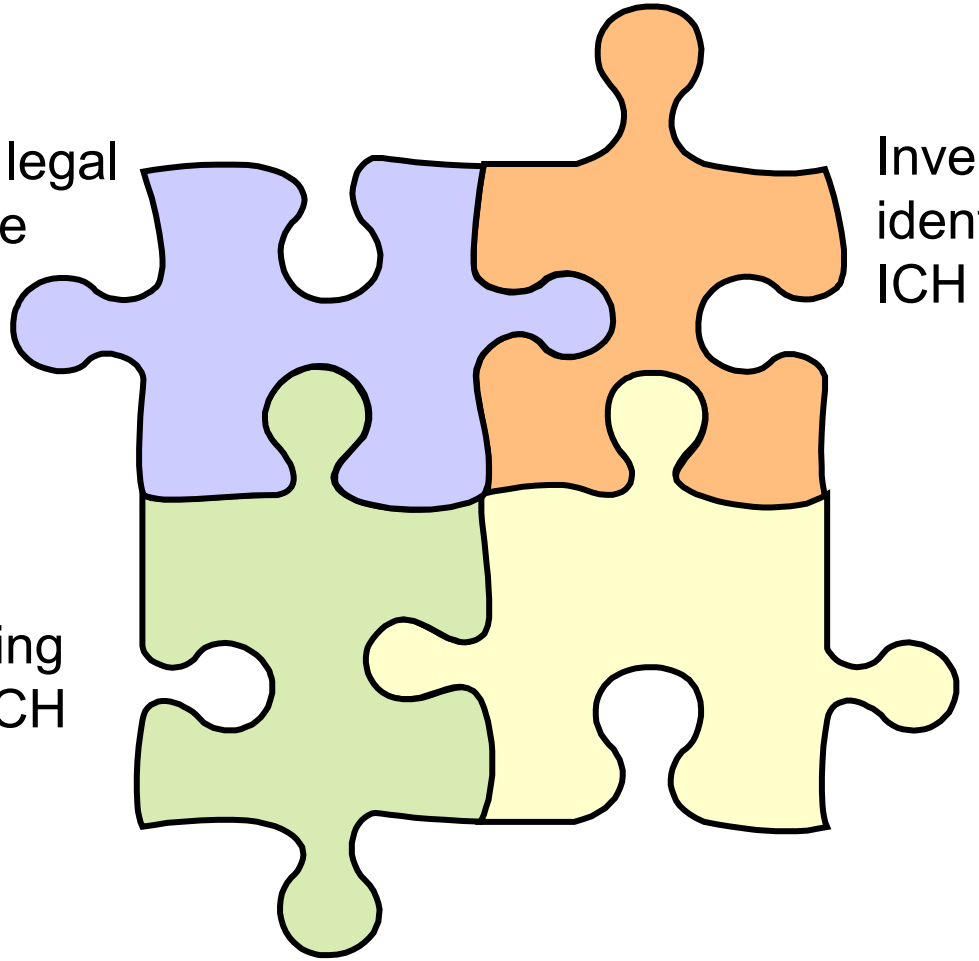
States Parties shall try (by all appropriate means) to ...

- Adopt general policies
- Have institutions for safeguarding, training, management, documentation
- Involve communities in ICH management
- Foster research
- Ensure appropriate access
- Ensure respect for ICH
- Cooperate internationally

Safeguarding at the national level

Creating a broad legal and administrative context

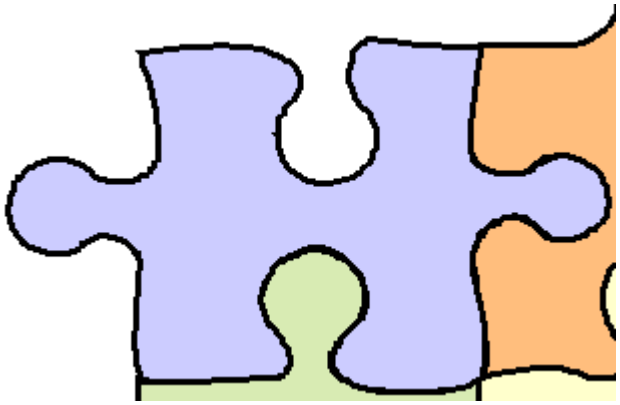
Inventorying, identifying, defining ICH elements



Awareness-raising about value of ICH

Implementing specific measures to safeguard ICH elements

Legal and administrative context



- Enhancing existing legislation, policies and institutions
- Amending legislation and policies, creating institutions
- Creating consultative bodies & cooperation mechanisms involving communities, NGOs, other stakeholders

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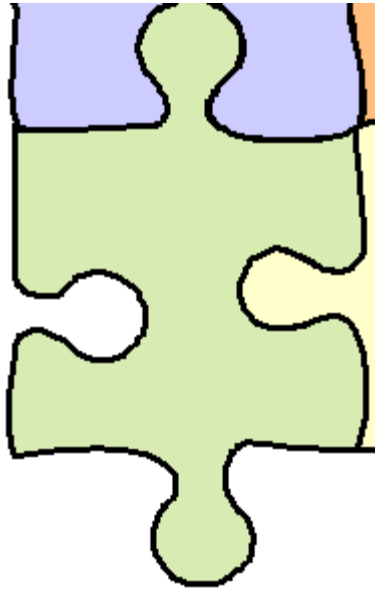
Awareness-raising about ICH



- Media campaigns
- Educational programmes
- Multimedia databases
- Seminars and workshops

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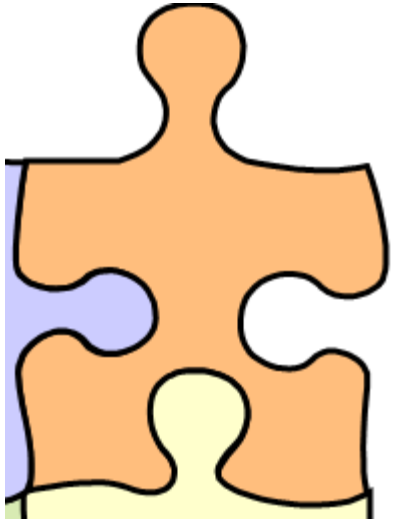
Identifying and inventorying ICH



What is identifying and inventorying ICH?

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Identifying and inventorying

- ICH in the territory of the State
- With the participation of communities, groups and individuals and relevant NGOs
- With a view to safeguarding
- While respecting customary practices governing access
- And while building relationships

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Inventorying

In a manner geared to their own situation

- Scope and size
- Criteria for inclusion
- Classifications
- In accordance with national legislation/policy
- Use of existing listings
- Advice from UNESCO

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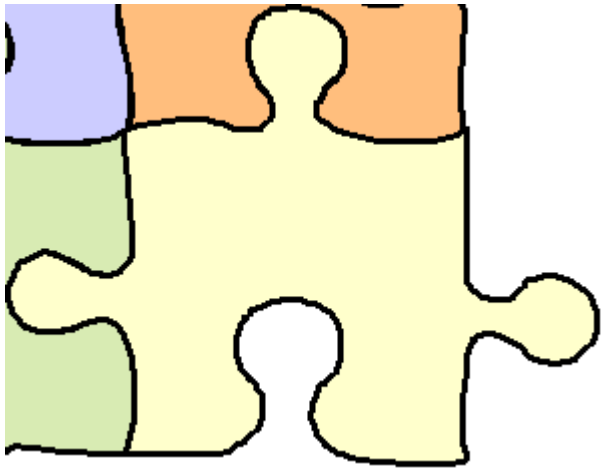
Safeguarding ICH



Safeguarding measures …

- may be general or may apply to specific ICH elements
- support communities and groups to ensure continued practice and transmission
- are based on an analysis of threats and risks, and the commitment of tradition bearers

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The Voladores ceremony (Mexico)

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Threats to viability - 1

The flight of the Voladores around the pole is the climax of a set of rituals

Increasingly only this part of the set of rituals is performed, for tourists, outside the community context

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Threats to viability - 2

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Poles for the ceremony were traditionally cut down in the forest and ritually prepared.

Too few appropriate trees, now using fixed metal poles

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Threats to viability - 3

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Ritual preparations for the ceremony help in maintaining its significance for the community.

Performance by professional dancers reduces focus on ritual aspects.

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In conclusion ...

States Parties to the Convention are obliged to

- take measures ensuring the safeguarding of the ICH on their territory;
- identify, inventory, and manage the ICH, with the participation of communities and groups concerned; and
- report to the Intergovernmental Committee every six years about the measures taken.

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